SEVEN-G

Consultant · Supporting clients

What SEVEN-G is, how the use case funnel gets filled all the way to the board dashboard, and how to apply it at your clients under your own name.

Fernando García Varela · Self-learning course · CC BY 4.0 · Examples with fictitious data

The problem it solves

- Many companies have AI pilots that work, but few reach production.
- Value gets declared ("we freed up 200 hours") and almost nobody checks it.
- Nobody has clear authority to stop a use case that is not working.
- The board asks about AI and gets a list of technical projects, not business decisions.
- Is the company transforming with AI, or just a bit more efficient? Almost nobody can answer that with evidence.

This is not a technology problem: it is a governance and measurement problem.

What SEVEN-G is and what it delivers

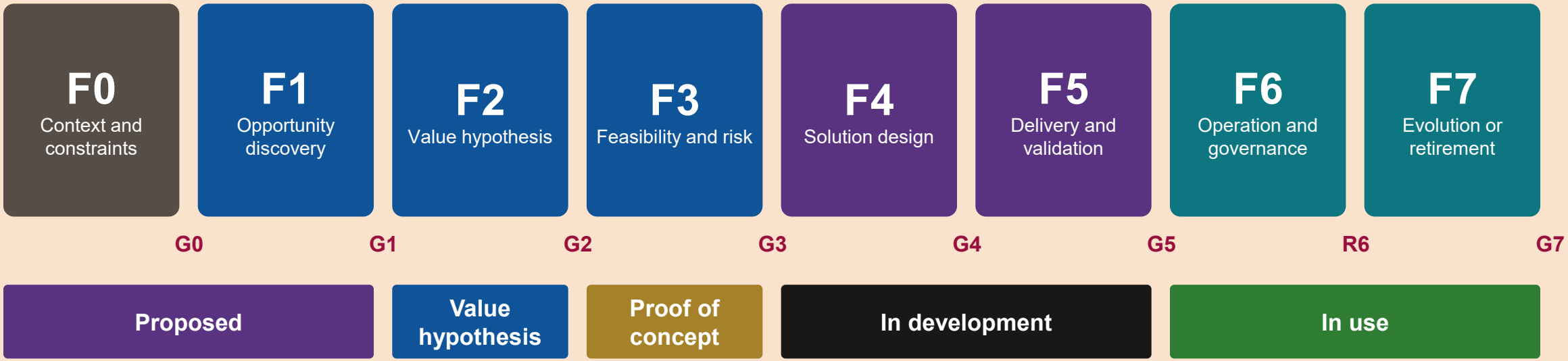
- Seven-phase Enterprise Value & Governance: an enabling phase 0 and seven value phases, with governance throughout.
- It organises AI as a portfolio: every use case has a phase, a cost, expected value and an owner.
- It places decision gates between phases: no verified evidence, no progress.
- It separates who decides, who builds and who controls, and turns regulation into phases, roles and evidence.
- It measures value in money and with a status —validated, declared or estimated— and shows it to the board on a dashboard.
- It is free and modifiable: documents, Word templates and tools, under an open licence.

Two levels: the company and each use case

- C1 · Diagnosis: inventory, maturity across seven dimensions and the transformation index.
- C2 · Direction: the board approves the AI thesis, ambition per sphere and risk appetite.
- C3 · Portfolio: which use cases get funded, and in what order.
- C4 · Oversight: board dashboard and the log of decisions and recommendations.
- C5 · Annual review: what worked, what did not and what changes.
- And, inside that portfolio, each use case goes through its own eight-phase lifecycle.

A use case's lifecycle

Eight phases with a decision gate at the end of each; below, the funnel stage where each phase shows up



What can happen at each gate

Five outcomes; whoever provides the evidence never verifies it or decides

Proceed	With conditions	Iterate	Pivot	Stop
All criteria are met and the evidence is verified: it moves to the next phase.	It proceeds, with a deadline and owner for what is pending. Never for critical security, legal or human-oversight controls.	The phase repeats with a specific adjustment and returns to the same gate. The third time, the higher body decides.	The hypothesis does not hold but another reasonable one exists: back to phase 2. Only at G1, G2 and G3.	No plausible value, or unacceptable risk. The reason and lessons are recorded. It is a good outcome.

At G7 the outcomes are Scale, Iterate or Retire.

FROM DOCUMENT TO DASHBOARD

How the funnel gets filled

Nobody draws the funnel or the dashboard: they come out of what is filled in and decided at each phase. This is the path.

Phases 0 to 3: from idea to proof of concept

What is done, which templates are filled in and which gate closes each phase

F0
Context and constraints

What is done. The idea is authorised: sponsor, owner, scope, constraints and intensity (Lite or Enterprise).

Filled in. P01 Use case charter · P02 Context and constraints · P03 Roles · P04 Intensity · P05 Inventory entry.

G0 → enters "Proposed"

F1
Discovery

What is done. Opportunities are compared, including non-AI alternatives, and a sphere and ambition level are proposed.

Filled in. P06 Opportunity portfolio and screening · P07 Sphere and ambition · P31 Use case sheet.

G1 → stays in "Proposed"

F2
Value hypothesis

What is done. A falsifiable hypothesis in money, with baseline, attribution method and stop criteria set in advance.

Filled in. P08 Value hypothesis canvas · P09 Baseline. Support: T11 calculator.

G2 → "Value hypothesis"

F3
Feasibility and risk

What is done. Proof of concept: feasibility, regulatory classification, risks and suppliers. It is the main stop gate.

Filled in. P10 Feasibility · P11 Regulatory classification and impact · P12 Risks · P13 Mitigation · P14 Supplier.

G3 → "Proof of concept"

Every gate decision is recorded in P29 and in the T01 register, with the status of each criterion and its evidence.

Phases 4 to 7: from design to production and retirement

Go-live does not close the cycle: it opens operation, with periodic reviews

F4
Solution design

What is done. Before building: architecture, data and model lineage, human oversight, security, rollback and adoption.

Filled in. P15 Architecture · P16 Lineage · P17 Human oversight · P18 Security · P19 Rollback · P20 Adoption.

G4 → "In development"

F5
Delivery and validation

What is done. Build, validate and pilot; the rollback is tested and go-live is signed off.

Filled in. P21 Delivery report · P22 Validation and pilot · P23 Go-live sign-off · P12 updated.

G5 → moves to "In use"

F6
Operation and governance

What is done. Monitoring, incidents, changes and tracking of realised value, with a periodic continuity review.

Filled in. P24 Operations manual · P25 Monitoring · P26 and P27 Incidents and changes · P28 Value · P65 R6 pack.

R6 → stays "In use" or brings G7 forward

F7
Evolution or retirement

What is done. With realised value on the table, the decision is to scale, iterate or retire, and lessons are recorded.

Filled in. P28 Value tracking · P30 Scale-or-retire decision, with a retirement plan where applicable.

G7 → scale, iterate or "Disengaged"

Every gate decision is recorded in P29 and in the T01 register, with the status of each criterion and its evidence.

The use case register (T01): where everything is recorded

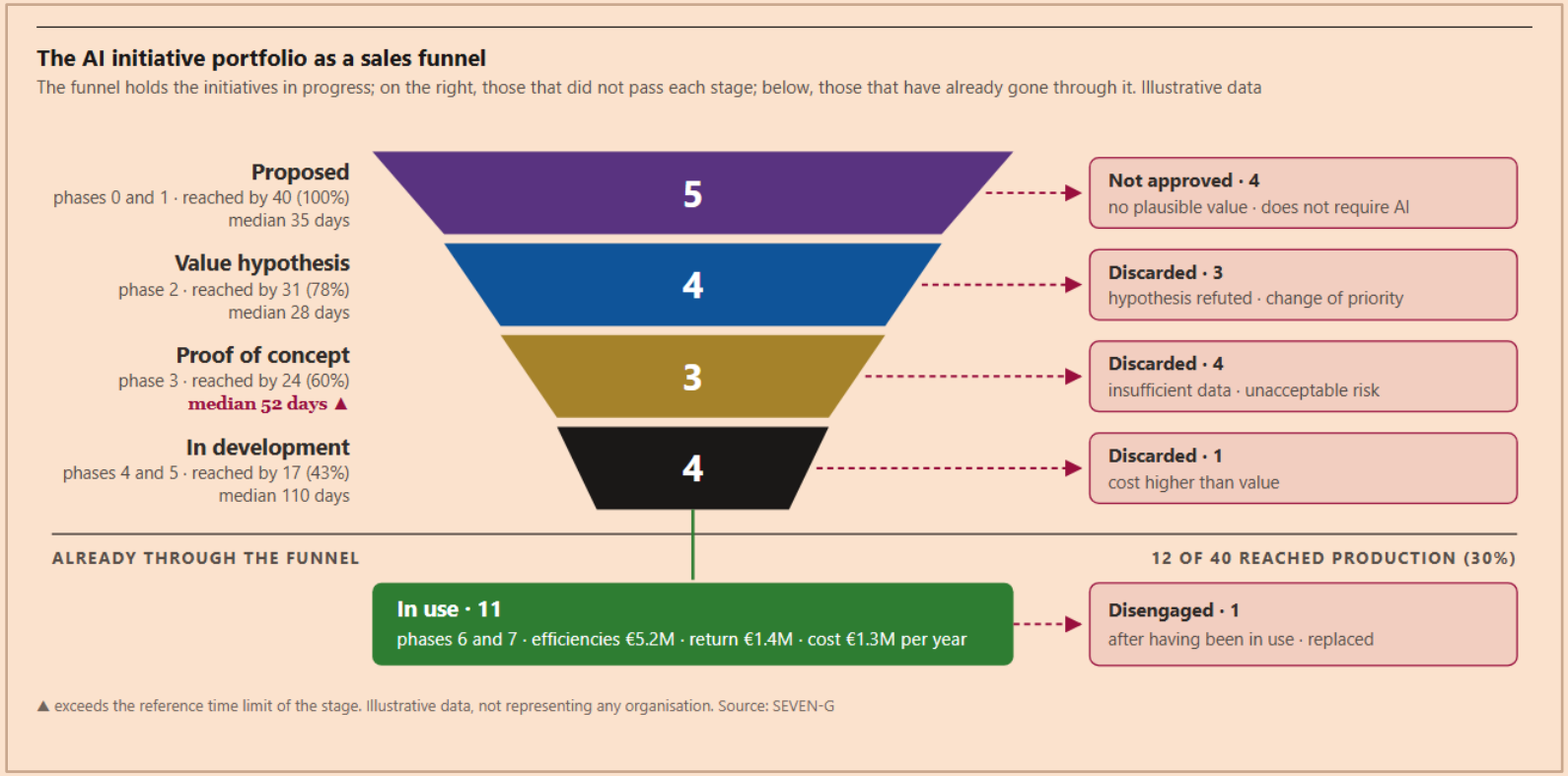
Each use case is entered like an opportunity in a CRM; here, the sample register with fictitious data



- One bar per phase: how many use cases are in each one now and how much expected value they carry.
- When a gate is decided, the register stores the date, the outcome, who verified and who decided, and the status of each criterion.
- From those dates it works out time in phase by itself and flags as "stalled" those beyond the reference time limit.
- Figures carry a status: validated, declared or estimated. What is unknown stays "no data", never zero.
- Alerts: pending gates, overdue conditions, risks without an owner.
- Everything is saved in the company's own JSON file: no server and no data sent to anyone.

The portfolio funnel: how to read it

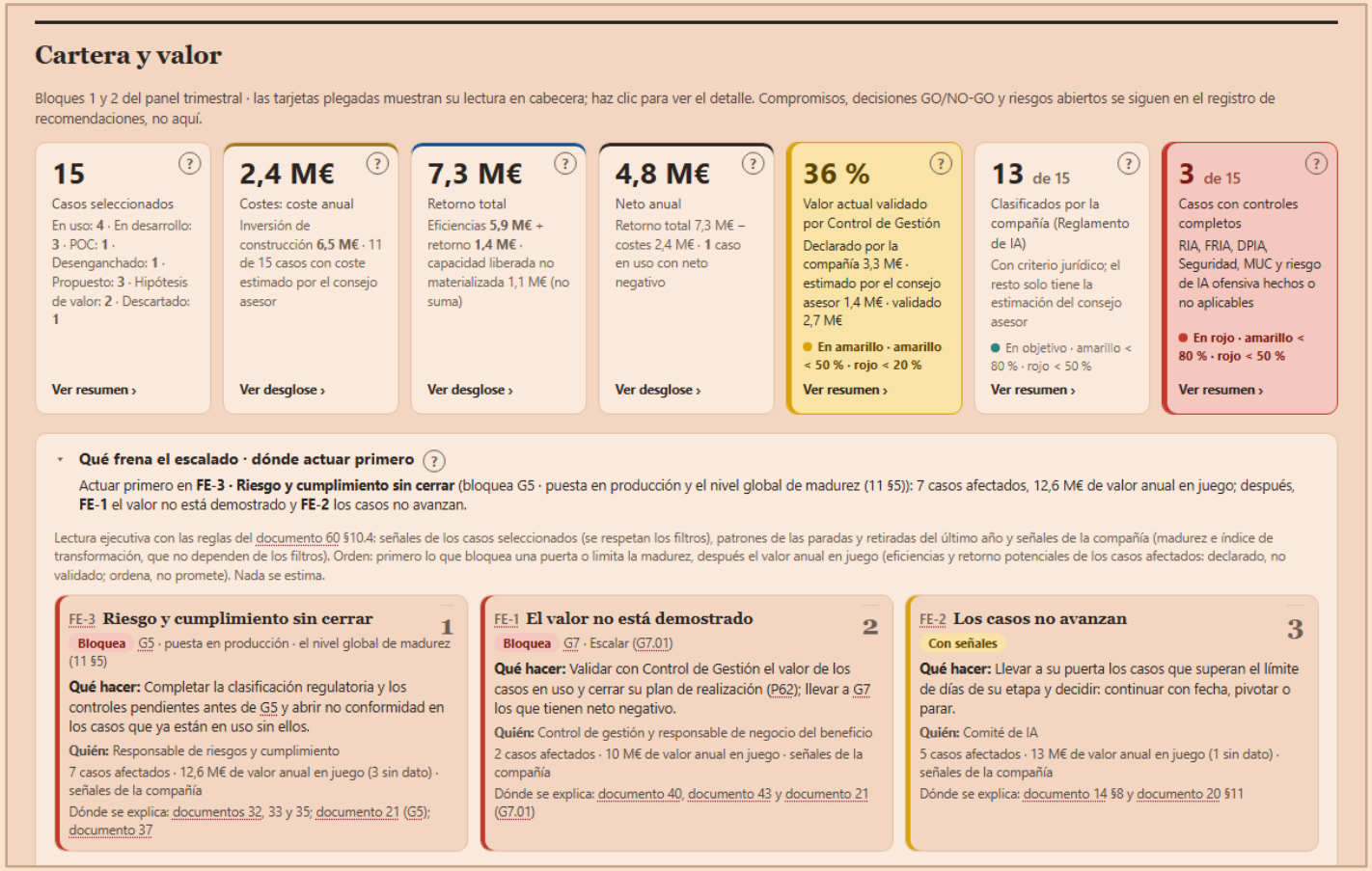
The AI portfolio, read as a sales funnel. Illustrative data



- Inside the funnel, only what is in progress: 5 proposed, 4 with a value hypothesis, 3 in proof of concept and 4 in development.
- On the left, how many reached each stage (40 → 31 → 24 → 17) and how long they take. The red triangle warns: proof of concept exceeds its time limit.
- On the right, those that did not pass each stage and why: no plausible value, hypothesis refuted, unacceptable risk, cost above value.
- Below, those that made it through: 11 in use, with their value and cost, and 1 disengaged.
- The goal is not to convert more: stopping an unviable use case at G3 is a good outcome. 100% conversion would point to soft gates.

The board dashboard (T17): how to read it

It is generated from the same register, with nothing typed twice. Fictitious data



- At the top, the figures: 15 cases, costs of €2.4M a year, total return of €7.3M and annual net of €4.8M. Each figure can be clicked to open its cases.
- The yellow card is the one that matters: only 36% of the value is validated by finance. In red: only 3 of 15 cases have all the controls.
- Below, «What holds back scaling»: the three barriers to start with, with what they block, what to do, who and the value at stake (document 60 §10.4).
- In the example: first risk and compliance (blocks G5), then unvalidated value (blocks G7 · Scale) and cases that do not move forward.
- The value at stake ranks, it does not promise: it is declared, not validated.

If a figure on the dashboard looks wrong, the dashboard is not touched: the evidence is fixed in the register and it is generated again.

Where the impact is: spheres × ambition

The portfolio heat map (T16) in the same dashboard. Fictitious data



Dónde está el impacto: esferas × nivel de ambición (T16)

El **51 %** de la inversión y el coste está en **Aumentar**; la esfera con más gasto es **01 Cliente** (40 %); el mayor neto anual está en **01 Cliente** (3,5 M€); sin actividad: 05 Datos; brecha frente a la ambición objetivo de C2 en 02 Producto y servicio (Transformar), 03 Personas (Aumentar), 05 Datos (Aumentar), 06 Conocimiento (Aumentar), 07 Decisión (Optimizar).

Mapa de calor del documento 10 §8 sobre los casos seleccionados: casos activos que han superado G0 y, aparte, los parados o retirados en los últimos 12 meses. Cada celda: casos (en uso), inversión de construcción y coste recurrente anual, neto anual y valor validado. Color: proporción de la inversión y el coste de la celda sobre el total de las filas (umbrales de partida, a calibrar en C5). Marcas: brecha (el nivel objetivo de C2 no tiene ningún caso que haya superado G2), fuera de tesis, sin evidencia (más de 12 meses en uso sin valor validado) y secundaria. La ambición objetivo de C2 es la de la tesis DEC-2025-001 del registro de iniciativas. Pulsa una celda para ver sus casos.

Por esfera | Por unidad de negocio — *2 propuestas sin G0 no cuentan*

ESFERA	OPTIMIZAR	AUMENTAR	TRANSFORMAR	TOTAL
01 Cliente objetivo C2: Aumentar Secundaria · 2	—	**2** 1 en uso · 3,4 M€ inversión y coste neto anual 3,5 M€ 1 con ambición solo propuesta Objetivo C2	—	**2** 40 % · neto anual 3,5 M€
02 Producto y servicio objetivo C2: Transformar Secundaria · 1	—	—	**1** 0 en uso · 480 k€ inversión y coste aún no produce · potencial 9,5 M€ Brecha Objetivo C2	**1** 6 % · aún no produce · potencial 9,5 M€
03 Personas objetivo C2: Aumentar Parados o retirados · 1	**1** 1 en uso · 1,7 M€ inversión y coste neto anual -440 k€ · validado 540 k€	— Brecha Objetivo C2	—	**1** 20 % · neto anual -440 k€
04 Operaciones objetivo C2: Optimizar Secundaria · 2	**4** 2 en uso · 1,9 M€ inversión y coste neto anual 1,8 M€ · validado 2,1 M€ Objetivo C2	—	—	**4** 22 % · neto anual 1,8 M€
05 Datos objetivo C2: Aumentar Secundaria · 3	—	— Brecha Objetivo C2	—	—
06 Conocimiento objetivo C2: Aumentar Secundaria · 3 Parados o retirados · 1	**1** 0 en uso · 95 k€ inversión y coste aún no produce	— Brecha Objetivo C2	—	**1** 1 % · aún no produce
07 Decisión objetivo C2: Optimizar	— Brecha Objetivo C2	**1** 0 en uso · 960 k€ inversión y coste aún no produce · potencial 1,2 M€	—	**1** 11 % · aún no produce · potencial 1,2 M€

- Rows: the areas where AI creates value (customer, product, people, operations, data, knowledge, decision). Columns: optimise, augment, transform.
- Each cell: cases, investment and cost, annual net and validated value; the colour shows where spending is concentrated.
- «Gap»: the ambition management approved in C2 for that sphere has no case that has passed G2.
- In the example: 40% of spending is in Customer, Data has no activity and five spheres have a gap.
- The target ambition comes from the thesis approved in the register; it is not written in the dashboard.

The question it answers: where does AI have most impact in the company and where are we not playing? (document 10 §8)

TWO EXAMPLES

One use case that stops and one that reaches production

Fictitious, illustrative data: they do not describe any real company.

Example 1 · When a use case stops

Candidate screening in recruitment (HR)

- Phases 0 and 1: HR sponsors it (P01–P05). Because it decides about people, intensity is Enterprise (P04). It enters "Proposed".
- Phase 2: the hypothesis (P08) promises 40% less screening time against the baseline (P09). The pilot confirms it: G2, Proceed.
- Phase 3: the regulatory classification (P11) makes it a high-risk system. The bias test finds it penalises older candidates.
- It iterates twice, adjusting variables: fixing the bias destroys the predictive power that justified the project.
- G3: high residual risk with no viable mitigation (P12, P13). The AI committee decides to Stop; it is recorded in P29 with its reason.
- In the funnel it shows to the right of "Proof of concept": Discarded · unacceptable risk. Lesson: test for bias earlier, in phase 2.

STOPPED AT G3 · BUILDING AND RUNNING AN UNVIABLE SYSTEM WAS AVOIDED

Use case 1, on the lifecycle

It reached phase 3 and did not pass gate G3



STOPPED AT G3 · it leaves the funnel as "Discarded", with its reason

Example 2 · When a use case reaches production

First-line IT incident response assistant

- Phases 0 and 1: IT sponsors it; against the non-AI alternative (more staff), the operations sphere with Optimise ambition is proposed (P07).
- Phase 2: hypothesis of 30% less resolution time for simple incidents; the controlled pilot yields 32%.
- Phase 3: no relevant bias, medium residual risk accepted by the right body (P12), supplier assessed (P14). G3, Proceed.
- Phases 4 and 5: mandatory human oversight above a severity level (P17), tested rollback (P19) and go-live sign-off (P23).
- Phase 6: fourteen months in use. Finance validates €1.1M a year (P28); released capacity was reassigned to complex incidents.
- In the funnel it sits under "In use"; on the dashboard it adds to annual net because its value is validated, not declared.

IN PRODUCTION · €1.1M OF VALIDATED ANNUAL RETURN · QUARTERLY R6

Use case 2, on the lifecycle

It went through phases 0 to 6 and remains in use; phase 7 will come with G7



IN USE · each R6 confirms it keeps delivering value under control

How value is measured

- Every amount carries a formula and a status: validated (finance), declared (the team) or estimated.
- Released hours are not savings until they are materialised: a cost goes down or they are reassigned to a valuable activity.
- Cost is complete: build, consumption, operation, human oversight and retirement.
- The transformation index uses eight evidence signals to tell transformation apart from mere efficiency.
- Ten measurement rules (document 40). No figure enters the portfolio net without its status.

FOR THE CONSULTANT

Applying SEVEN-G at clients, under your own name

The licence allows it, including in paid services and without hiring the author. In return it asks for fidelity, independence and honesty.

What the licence allows and what you take on

- You may use, adapt and apply the framework in paid services without asking permission: credit the author, indicate changes and do not suggest endorsement.
- You answer to your client for your service: SEVEN-G is a reference framework, not a guarantee of results.
- You state which version you apply and what you have adapted, in every deliverable.
- Client information is not used with other clients or in examples, not even anonymised, without written authorisation.
- Regulatory classification and legal matters require qualified legal judgement; carry the legal notice into your deliverables.

Document 91, section 2, and document 93.

Six rules you cannot drop without saying so

- Segregation of duties: whoever builds does not control, and nobody approves themselves.
- Dual validation at the gates and a real ability to stop.
- The ten measurement rules: a status for every amount, and released capacity does not count until materialised.
- Ambition classified with the five questions.
- Maturity based on observable evidence, not self-assessment.
- A recommendations log with persistent identifiers and independent assessment.

If you drop any, your service may be inspired by SEVEN-G, but must not be presented as an application of SEVEN-G.

Five engagement models

What each one delivers; durations are indicative

M1 · Diagnosis	M2 · Implementation	M3 · Audit	M4 · Board advisory	M5 · Ongoing support
4 to 6 weeks. Inventory, evidence-based maturity (T15), transformation index (T14), current value and cost. C1 report (P33).	90 days. Thesis and risk appetite, governance, portfolio, T01 register and dashboard with real data, and the first board pack.	Independent opinion: Compliant, Compliant with observations or Non-compliant. Plan, working papers and report (P58, P59, P60).	Annual mandate. Preparing sessions, reviewing the quarterly pack, logged recommendations and independent assessments.	Support to the AI office: register, funnel metrics and packs, always with a transfer plan and an exit date (P71).

In all of them the company decides; you prepare, propose, verify or advise.

Independence: whoever implements does not audit

- You cannot independently verify, audit or assess what you, your firm or a related entity designed, implemented or operated.
- Implementation (M2) and audit (M3) are incompatible for the same scope; neither is advising the board (M4) on what you operate (M5).
- After an incompatible service, let at least one full annual cycle pass before auditing that scope.
- Declare in writing your relationships with technology vendors, your own tools and your fee scheme (P41).
- Value-linked fees: only on value validated by finance or by an audit that is not yours.

Document 91, section 5.

What you can and cannot say

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Yes	No	Do not promise
"Service based on SEVEN-G (version …), a framework by Fernando García Varela, CC BY 4.0." "Methodology adapted from SEVEN-G; changes: …" "Uses the sphere map and measurement rules of SEVEN-G."	"SEVEN-G certified", "accredited consultancy", "official partner", "endorsed by the author": there is no certification or partner programme. Nor "compliance guaranteed by SEVEN-G".	X% savings before the diagnosis, a maturity level by a date, "your company will transform", "no risk", or implementation deadlines without a diagnosis.

Document 91, sections 6 and 8.

Your templates and leaving the engagement

- P70 Proposal and engagement letter: scope, model (M1–M5), out of scope, roles on both sides and independence.
- P41 Declaration of independence and conflicts of interest, at the start of every M3 or M4 service.
- Quality: every deliverable states version and adaptations, links its evidence and is reviewed by a second professional.
- P71 Transfer plan and exit note: registers in open format, evidence located, pending items with an owner and open risks.
- The test of good work: the company does not need you to read or maintain anything you delivered.

Thank you

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